RESOLUTION NO. 2026-79

SUBMITTING A BALLOT MEASURE TO THE CITY OF CERES QUALIFIED VOTERS TO VOTE ON A GENERAL LOCAL ONE CENT (1¢) SALES TAX BALLOT MEASURE ENTITLED "CERES 911 EMERGENCY RESPONSE, COMMUNITY SAFETY, ESSENTIAL SERVICES MEASURE"

THE CITY COUNCIL
City of Ceres

WHEREAS, through community input, the City of Ceres has heard from hundreds of residents about the need to keep our city safe, clean, and preserve our quality of life; and

WHEREAS, smaller cities our size often do not get our fair share of money or attention, while the State government also faces a multi-billion-dollar budget crisis and has taken millions of dollars from cities like Ceres in the past; and

WHEREAS, this year alone, the City cut nearly $5.6 million from the budget and services to address Ceres' budget deficit; and

WHEREAS, nearly 70% of all 911 calls in Ceres are for medical emergencies, and funding from the proposed measure will help ensure we have enough on-duty local first-responders to provide fast and effective life-saving emergency services; and

WHEREAS, additional local funding is needed to address homelessness, clear encampments, and help get people off the streets by bringing together non-profits and regional services; and

WHEREAS, all funds generated by this measure are locally controlled, cannot be taken by the county, state or federal government and can only be used to benefit Ceres residents; and

WHEREAS, this funding will help stabilize the City's budget and maintain essential community and neighborhood services our residents have told us they prioritize, such as maintaining emergency 911 response times and police officer patrols, hiring and retaining qualified police officers, preventing gang activity coming from nearby cities, and clearing encampments and addressing homelessness; and

WHEREAS, this measure includes accountability requirements to ensure transparency and public oversight, including independent annual financial/performance audits, public spending disclosure, and citizen oversight to ensure funds are used effectively and efficiently; and

WHEREAS, pursuant to Elections Code section 9222, the City Council is submitting to City voters a ballot measure and proposed ordinance to establish a one cent (1¢) sales tax for general City revenue purposes (the "Measure"); and

WHEREAS, this Measure is not a tax on homes or property, and by law, will not be applied to food purchased as groceries or prescription medication; and

WHEREAS, a statewide general election will be held on November 3, 2026; and

WHEREAS, the City Council desires to place the Measure on the November 3, 2026, ballot.

NOW, THEREFORE, THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF CERES, CALIFORNIA, DOES RESOLVE, DECLARE, DETERMINE, AND ORDER AS FOLLOWS:

SECTION 1: Pursuant to Revenue and Taxation Code section 7285.9 and Government Code section 53724, the City Council by this Resolution approves by a two-thirds (2/3) vote the Measure. The Measure is a general tax as defined in Article XIII C of the State of California Constitution and Government Code section 53721 and shall not take effect until approved by a vote of at least a majority of voters voting on the question at the November 3, 2026, election.

SECTION 2: Pursuant to Elections Code section 9222, the City Council hereby submits the following question to the voters at the election on November 3, 2026:

*"**CERES 911 EMERGENCY RESPONSE, COMMUNITY SAFETY, ESSENTIAL SERVICES MEASURE.** Shall the measure to maintain 911 response/police patrols; hire/retain qualified police officers; prevent gang activity from nearby cities; address homelessness/clear encampments; maintain essential and general city services, by establishing a 1¢ local sales tax providing approximately $9,400,000 annually until ended by voters, requiring independent audits, public spending disclosure, all funds benefitting Ceres residents, no money for the State, with citizens' oversight, be adopted?"*	Yes
	No

SECTION 3: The text of the ordinance submitted to the voters is attached as **Exhibit A.**

SECTION 4: The City Council hereby directs the City Elections Official, or designee, to file a certified copy of this Resolution with the Stanislaus County Board of Supervisors and the Stanislaus County Registrar of Voters office on or before July 6, 2026.

SECTION 5: Pursuant to Elections Code section 9280, the City Council hereby directs the City Elections Official, or designee, to transmit a copy of the Measure to the City Attorney. The City Council hereby directs the City Attorney to prepare an impartial

analysis of the Measure pursuant to Elections Code section 9280 (the "Impartial Analysis"). The City Attorney shall file the Impartial Analysis with the Registrar on or before August 3, 2026.

SECTION 6: Pursuant to Elections Code sections 9282 and 9285, the City Council or a member or members of the legislative body authorized by the City Council, or an individual voter who is eligible to vote on the measure, or a bona fide association of citizens, or a combination of voters and associations, may file a written argument for the measure and a rebuttal to any arguments against the measure. An argument shall not exceed 300 words in length, and a rebuttal argument cannot exceed 250 words in length. Arguments for and against the Measure, and any rebuttals, may be filed in accordance with applicable provisions of the law.

SECTION 7: The City Elections Officials and other City officers and employees are authorized and directed to take all other actions that are necessary to have the Measure properly submitted to the City voters at the Election, to be conducted on Tuesday, November 3, 2026. The City Clerk shall be the City Elections Official.

PASSED AND ADOPTED by a two-thirds vote by the City Council of the City of Ceres at a regular meeting held on the 22nd day of June 2026, by the following vote:

AYES:	Councilmembers: Martinez, Otero, Vierra & Mayor Lopez
NOES:	Councilmembers: Casey
ABSENT:	Councilmembers: None
ABSTAIN:	Councilmembers: None

APPROVED:

Javier Lopez, Mayor

ATTEST:

Fallon Martin, City Clerk, Elections Official